EMBERLINE

01 / BLAZE-CENTERED WORLD & STORY BIBLE

The project in one sentence

Emberline: The Crimson Flame is a complete, story-led 2D action-platformer in which Blaze, a nineteen-year-old guard who blames herself for her captain’s sacrifice, travels through six corrupted regions to restore one borrowed dawn and learn the difference between defeating enemies and protecting people.

Creative canon and decisions

Status	Rule
Established canon	The Great Beacon is fed by love; the Hush silences and freezes people; nine districts hold nine hearth shards; Blaze is the youngest Forge Gate guard; Captain Alden is Hushed while saving her; six zones end at the Summit; one hero restores only a day of light.
Expanded for Blaze campaign	Her parents Rowan and Mira, childhood fire incident, guard trials, sword Emberfang, playable tutorial, and detailed dialogue are additions developed for this edition.
Version 1 decision	Only Blaze is playable. All nine heroes exist in the world and character-select roster, but the other eight campaigns are explicitly future content.
Future true ending	After all nine heroes have completed their journeys, their connections restore the Beacon permanently. The Hollow Crown finale is a proposed later expansion, not Version 1 content.

World rules

- The Great Beacon stands at the Summit and once protected the valley from the Long Night. Each of the nine districts keeps one hearth linked to it.
- The Hush spreads cold silence; people touched by it become Hushed, frozen mid-action rather than killed. Restoration is possible.
- Mopes are small fragments of the Hush. Contact extinguishes warmth; defeating them releases sparks.
- Waystation beacons are checkpoints and narrative landmarks. Lighting one pushes back local Hush and reveals one short piece of Blaze’s memory.
- One recovered shard grants a borrowed dawn, bringing Forge Gate back temporarily. The flame fades at sunset; the restored shard remains as lasting progress toward nine.

Why Blaze is the main character

The original ensemble story becomes Blaze’s immediate point of view. The opening shows Forge Gate while it is still alive. The Hush then takes Captain Alden in front of the player. All six regions challenge one layer of her grief. The climax is not a larger sword attack, but Blaze choosing restraint, retreat, rescue, and finally self-forgiveness.

Childhood, family, mentor

- Rowan: her father, a blacksmith who forged Emberfang. He teaches that fire can create or destroy.
- Mira: her mother, a retired guard whose leg was injured defending travelers. She teaches that brave people sometimes turn back.
- Alden: veteran captain, mentor, and the person who names Blaze’s flaw during her guard trial: she defeats opponents but fails to protect the objective.
- Blaze: fast, stubborn, loyal, fiercely protective, privately self-critical; she has mistaken never retreating for bravery since childhood.

The complete six-zone route

Chapter	Boss / encounter	Blaze’s emotional lesson
Prologue: Forge Gate	Training with Alden; Hush invasion	Failure to obey retreat order; Alden saves her
1 · Forgotten Meadow	The Great Mope	Anger must give way to purpose
2 · Hollow Hills	The Rolling Gloom	Running can save someone
3 · Weeping Woods	The Thornmother	Not everything corrupted should be destroyed
4 · Echoing Caves	The Echo Maw	Guilt cannot be fought away
5 · Broken River	The Undertow; optional Retreat room	Protection can require putting the sword away
6 · Beacon Summit	Blaze’s Shadow	Acceptance, patience, and self-forgiveness
Epilogue: Forge Gate	Borrowed dawn	One ember is a beginning, not the final victory

Narrative themes and how to show them

- Show the bond with Alden by letting the player spar with him, not only hear an explanation.

- Let environment tell the story: grey statues, interrupted work, cold lanterns, color returning as beacons reignite.
- Keep dialogue short during levels. Use compact conversations at checkpoints and brief cinematic beats after bosses.
- Set up the line “One flame may guide you. Nine flames will bring you home” as a recurring mystery before explaining it.

Supporting roster (future, not playable in Version 1)

Hero	District	Story connection
Trek	Wayfinder’s Rest	Explorer searching for his missing father
Sage	Archive Spire	Apprentice studying the Hush and old texts
Sprout	Greenhouse Commons	Gardener trying to save his sister Fern
Marshal	Citadel	Commander’s heir who must learn to trust others
Bubbles	Lantern Market	Bakery worker who hides her fear behind optimism
Dash	Arena	Athlete whose entire team was Hushed
Turbo	Gearworks Speedway	Racer trying to save his sister Vela
Banner	Commonhall	Herald connecting the districts, future late unlock

Continuity lock

Blaze cannot permanently rescue Alden alone. He awakens during her borrowed dawn, embraces her, and becomes Hushed again after sunset. The shard she restores remains lit at the Summit, allowing a future hero to continue. Optional Turning Points enrich the ending but must not be required to complete the story.

Out-of-scope for Version 1

No playable Trek/Sage/Sprout/Marshal/Bubbles/Dash/Turbo/Banner campaigns; no online MMO; no nine-hero final boss; no AI-generated runtime code; no unfinished systems disguised as completed features.